Multiplication counts equal groups

I can... explain the factors and product in an equal-group model.

Four groups of 3

$4 \times 3 = 3 + 3 + 3 + 3 = 12$

Name what each number counts

4 counts the groups. 3 counts objects in each group. 12 counts all the objects.

The groups must be equal

Groups of 3, 3, 2, and 4 have 12 objects, but do not model four equal groups of 3.